

GAMING TEST				
HP VICTUS 16 GAMING TEST (FPS @HIGH 1080P)				
GAME	SHADOW OF THE TOMB RAIDER	ASSASSINS CREED VALHALLA	METRO EXODUS	DIRT 5
HP VICTUS 16	130	101	78	100
ACER PREDATOR HELIOS NEO 16	136	96	86	93
LENOVO LEGION 5i PRO	126	113	86	93
MSI GL66 12UEK	95	74	71	63

The speakers are also pretty capable. They are loud but lack base, just like most Windows gaming laptops. But they do have clarity. As a result, you do not miss out on any in-game dialogue.

Lastly, the webcam on the HP Victus 16 is a 2.1MP unit that supports a maximum resolution of 1080p in photo and video mode. It can also record footage in FHD at 30FPS, which is about what I'd expect from a gaming laptop. But a 60FPS version would be nice to see in future iterations. Especially considering that people will use these machines to stream themselves while playing games.

GAMING AND PERFORMANCE

The HP Victus 16 features the latest CPU and GPU from team Blue and Green respectively. The HP gaming laptop uses an Intel Core i5-13500HX 14-core processor and an Nvidia GeForce RTX 4050 with 6GB GDDR6 VRAM and 120W TGP. Paired with this setup is also a very powerful (and loud) cooling system that works wonders. Let me explain how.

Starting off with the CPU benchmarks, the Intel Core i5-13500HX powering the HP Victus 16 scored 15178

in a single run. And after a 10-minute throttle run, the laptop scored 15071, indicating a drop of just 107 points. It is the second-lowest performance drop I have seen in a laptop in this price range in 2023. Most of the time, this difference ranges from 300 to 1200 points on average. So the minor throttle difference in consistent performance makes the laptop a very capable machine. What's even more impressive is that the Core i5-13500HX touches the performance of the Core i7-13700HX in Geekbench 6 and downright performs as well as or better than the last year's Core i7-12700H.

What's also surprising here is the performance of RTX 4050. The 120W TGP unit takes charge and scores as well as its bigger brother the RTX 4060, at least in GPU benchmarks. Even in terms of Ray Tracing performance, the RTX 4050 sits very well within fighting distance of the RTX 4060. The same can also be seen if you compare these two's gaming performance. There is an 8FPS difference between the RTX 4050 and the 4060 while running Metro Exodus. The difference is much lower if you take into account a game like

Assassin's Creed Valhalla and Shadow of the Tomb Raider. The major FPS difference we see is in CPU-bound games like Civilization VI.

In other benchmarks like PC Mark 10 extended, which tests a laptop's overall capabilities, the HP Victus fares very well and the laptop also scores a commendable 7135MB/s read and 6793.91MB/s write speed for the 512GB SSD onboard. Meanwhile, in terms of battery life, the laptop scored 130 minutes of battery backup while gaming at 100% screen brightness.

VERDICT

The new HP Victus 16 corrects its past mistakes and emerges as a gaming laptop ripe with potential. The 16-inch Victus, unlike its previous generations, feels very solid and likewise employs a display hinge that is as solid as the laptop's cooling capabilities. The powerful fans also push the latest chip from Nvidia and Intel to a new high while keeping things nice and cool for the end user. Your initial hesitation at the laptop's big size will disappear after knowing how it utilizes the extra space to give a high performance consistently. At Rs 1.29 lakh, the 16-inch HP Victus ticks all the right boxes but leaves me wanting a QHD display, a full-size SD card slot, an additional USB type-C port, and more internal storage. If you're in the market for a 16-inch gaming laptop with awesome cooling performance, do not overlook the HP Victus 16. Personally, however, I'd rather go for the 15-inch version which essentially has the same CPU and GPU but uses DDR4 RAM instead of DDR5 and costs as low as Rs 1.04 lakh.

—Yetnesh Dubey

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Intel Core i5-13500HX | Graphics: Nvidia RTX 4050 GPU with 6GB GDDR6 VRAM and 120W TGP | RAM: 16GB DDR5 RAM at 4800MHz | Display: 16.1-inch FHD display with 165Hz refresh rate | Storage: 512GB Gen4 NVMe TLC M.2 SSD | Battery: 83Wh | Weight: 2.31kg

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